



Melbourne Archdiocese
Catholic Schools

2025

Annual Report to the School Community



Good Shepherd School

30 Academy Avenue, WHEELERS HILL 3150

Principal: Jacqueline Marshall

Web: www.goodshep.vic.edu.au

Registration: 1682, E Number: E1271

Principal's Attestation

I, Jacqueline Marshall, attest that Good Shepherd School is compliant with:

- The minimum standards and other requirements for school registration and school boarding premises (if applicable) as specified in the Education and Training Reform Act 2006 (Vic) and the Education and Training Reform Regulations 2017 (Vic).
- Australian Government accountability requirements related to the 2025 school year under the Australian Education Act 2013 (Cth) and the Australian Education Regulations 2023 (Cth).
- The Child Safe Standards as prescribed in Ministerial Order 1359 – Implementing the Child Safe Standards, Managing the Risk of Child Abuse in Schools and School Boarding Premises.

Attested on 01 Apr 2026

About this report

Good Shepherd School is registered by the Victorian Registration and Qualifications Authority (VRQA). The Annual Report to the School Community (ARSC), provides parents and the wider community with information about the school's activities and achievements throughout the year including information about various aspects of school performance. The Report is supplementary to other forms of regular communication to the school community regarding initiatives, activities and programs which support the learning and wellbeing of its students. Further information about the contents of this Report may be obtained by contacting the School directly or by visiting the School's website. Information can also be obtained from the [My School website](#).

Governing Authority Report

Melbourne Archdiocese Catholic Schools (MACS) continues to take bold and ambitious steps, guided by our MACS2030 strategy, to empower our students to flourish and step into the world as the leaders of tomorrow.

In advancing our 2030 vision and our ambition to deliver world-leading Catholic education, we celebrate the significant progress made across our four areas of strategic focus. The safety and wellbeing of our staff and students underpins everything we do, enabling an environment where learning grows with purpose, leadership develops in capability and confidence, and our communities continue to thrive through our shared Catholic outlook.

Inspired by faith in the Jubilee Year of the Catholic Church in 2025, we successfully implemented our Faith Formation Framework, to further strengthen faith education, offering deeper opportunities for spiritual development and meaningful engagement for students, staff and leaders alike. Faith is at the heart of all our schools, grounding our mission and inspiring students, teachers and staff to grow and lead with integrity.

The official launch and implementation of the Vision for Engagement (VFE) strategy demonstrated impressive results in our community of Flourishing Learners.

Anchored in evidence-based practise, the VFE strengthens our system-wide teaching and learning approach and enhances the daily engagement of students through the explicit teaching of positive behaviour, reinforcement and consistency. It sets clear expectations about attendance and includes a sustained focus on student mental health and wellbeing.

For learners to flourish, students must be safe, which is why we are continuing to strengthen our safety processes and risk management culture. Our focus is on providing training and professional development for all staff to ensure student safety remains top of mind in every decision we make, every environment we shape and every interaction we have.

To strengthen the pillar of enabled leaders, MACS has established consistent standards across schools for cultivating inspiring, capable leaders for students to observe.

In the past year, our Pathways to Principalship Programme and Women in Leadership Programme have both strengthened our principal appointment process and introduced more flexible models of principalship.

It is inspiring to see our principals and teachers continue to raise the bar, reflected in the extraordinary number of nominations received in our Best Teachers campaign.

Finally, we continue to create new and enriched communities, with the opening of a new primary school and children's hub in Melbourne's growing north, ensuring families have access to high quality education no matter where they live.

MACS Early Years Education (MACSEYE) continues to expand early years and outside school hours care services across our schools and communities, with continued growth planned for 2026.

These investments are not simply about building infrastructure. They are about building a dynamic, Catholic education system where every child has an opportunity to learn, grow and thrive.

Thank you to all our students, staff, families and community members for being part of our journey so far, and we look forward to continuing to serve as a supportive and guiding presence in your children's lives.

Yours sincerely,

Dr Edward Simons

Executive Director

Melbourne Archdiocese Catholic Schools Ltd

Vision and Mission

Our School Vision

At Good Shepherd School, our vision is to ensure that by the time our students graduate, they possess a deep sense of belonging within the Catholic community. We strive to create a school environment where lived faith and Christian values serve as guiding principles for all.

We are dedicated to immersing our school community in an atmosphere of genuine faith, where parents are also supported in their spiritual growth. We prioritise caring and supportive relationships, which are fundamental to each child's development. Our educational environment fosters a love of learning, celebrates individual successes, and nurtures a positive self-image, ensuring that every child is encouraged to achieve their fullest potential.

Our Mission Statement:

Our mission is to provide a high-quality, evidence-based education within a Catholic context, fostering each student's growth through continuous professional learning, strong community partnerships, and a commitment to nurturing every child to flourish and thrive.

Our School Values:

- Respect Self
- Respect Others
- Respect Property

School Overview

Good Shepherd School, Wheelers Hill, is a Catholic primary school within the Parish of Good Shepherd, Mulgrave, located approximately 26 kilometres south-east of Melbourne. Established in 1970, the school proudly celebrated 54 years of Catholic education in 2024.

Our school community is richly multicultural, with a wide range of nationalities represented. Approximately 70% of students come from families where parents were born overseas or are first-generation Australians, contributing to a diverse and inclusive environment.

In 2025, the school enrolment is approximately 480 students across 21 classes, with three classes at each year level from Prep to Year 6. Students have access to a broad and engaging curriculum, including specialist programs in Performing Arts, Visual Arts, Physical Education, Mandarin, STEM, and Library.

The school is set on eight acres of spacious grounds, featuring a large grassed oval with a running track, adventure playgrounds, a quadrangle with netball and basketball courts, and three tennis courts adjacent to the Performing Arts building.

The majority of students continue their secondary education within the Catholic system, most commonly attending Avila College, Sacred Heart College, and Mazenod College.

Principal's Report

It is with great pride as Principal at Good Shepherd Primary School that I present the 2025 Annual Report. The year has been one of significant achievement, continued growth as we remain a faith-filled and future-focused learning community.

A key highlight was the formation of a new leadership team to grow in our mission of providing Catholic education that strengthens teaching and learning, enhances wellbeing and builds meaningful partnerships with families and parish.

I am grateful for the exceptional leadership of the following staff:

Ferial Davis – Deputy Principal and Learning Diversity Leader
Kellie Cumming - Learning and Teaching Leader (English and Mathematics)
Vanessa Lamanna - Religious Education Leader
Megan Skoda - Student Wellbeing Leader

The life of a Catholic school, the partnership between parish and school is not simply supportive, it is foundational. I would like to take this opportunity to acknowledge with deep gratitude the ongoing guidance and presence of our Parish Priest Fr Andrzej Madry, whose leadership enriches the spiritual life of our community.

Together we achieved the following:

- Deepened our Catholic Identity and faith formation opportunities
- Continued to improve student outcomes through evidence-based teaching practices
- Supported staff professional growth and leadership development
- Promoted a safe, inclusive and respectful school environment

A Theme of Togetherness

Our 2025 theme, “Together We Can” speaks to the heart of who we are as a Catholic community. It is centred around the powerful message of unity, collaboration and shared purpose. This is deeply connected to the image of Jesus as the Good Shepherd, who knows, guides and cares for each member of the flock, ensuring no one is left behind. Our goal in 2025 was to walk together in both faith and learning to support one another to meet their potential - academically, socially, emotionally and spiritually.

Highlights from the 2025 School Year

There was much to celebrate as it has been a year filled with growth and achievement.

This has included the incredible success of our whole school performance of Aladdin. It was a true celebration of creativity, collaboration and dedication. Our students embraced their roles with enthusiasm and supported and encouraged one another. The spirit of “togetherness” was evident, highlighting the importance of perseverance, cooperation and mutual respect. I thank Shannen Wickremasinghe and Cara Decru for their amazing artistic and creative skills and talents in leading the school in our production year.

In the 5 spheres of school improvement we celebrate the following:

- Religious Dimension - the implementation of Christian Meditation to foster a sense of peace, reflection and connection to our faith
- Learning and Teaching - continued implementation of the Vision for Instruction which included leadership led learning walks to gauge school wide implementation of explicit instruction
- Student Wellbeing - implementation of the Vision for Engagement to foster a sense of belonging, promoting mental health and wellbeing and enabling motivation
- School Community - continued focus on effective communication and home/school partnerships
- Leadership and Management - celebrating the positive shift in MACSSIS data with notable improvements in perception of leadership, collaboration and psychological safety. These results highlight a strengthening culture of trust, shared responsibility and continuous improvement.

Looking Forward

As a united school community, we continue to build a place where faith, learning, and love flourish. Together, we walk with purpose, supporting one another and celebrating the journey ahead.

I remain deeply grateful for the support of our families, the commitment of our staff and the joy our students bring to learning.

Catholic Identity and Mission

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To improve authentic connections with faith and life through scripture in Year 6.

Intended Outcomes:

By the end of the year, in the MACSIS student survey, Year 6 student data will indicate at least a 60% overall school positive endorsement in all areas of the 'Catholic Identity' domain.

Targets:

By the end of the year, in the MACSIS student survey, Year 6 student data will indicate at least a 60% overall school positive endorsement in all areas of the 'Catholic Identity' domain.

Key Improvement Strategies:

If we provide consistent exposure of prayer and liturgical expression then we will improve authentic connections with faith and life through scripture in Year 6.

Achievements

The following targets were met:

- The Year 6 target of achieving at least 60% positive endorsement in the Catholic Identity domain was met, with students achieving 66% in the MACSSIS data.
- Students demonstrated improved understanding of prayer, Christian meditation, and scripture, as evidenced through pre- and post-mind map assessments showing growth in knowledge, confidence, and application.
- Teachers strengthened their practice through collaborative planning, professional learning, and the implementation of evidence-based strategies in prayer, meditation, and liturgical expression.
- Overall improvement was evident across the Catholic Identity domain, with Year 6 student results increasing compared to their Year 5 data in 2024 and aligning with or exceeding MACS averages in several areas.

- High levels of engagement in prayer were achieved, with 97% of students indicating that their class prays together regularly.

Impact on teacher/leader practice:

- Teachers strengthened their practice by conducting a collaborative audit of existing Year 6 practices in prayer and liturgical expression.
- Teachers enhanced student engagement and understanding by identifying strengths, gaps, and opportunities in these areas.
- The Year 6 team and leaders informed targeted planning by reviewing prior year data and identifying areas of lower student connection to Catholic Identity.
- Teachers established a baseline of student understanding by having students complete mind maps on prayer, Christian meditation, and scripture.
- Teachers planned differentiated instruction by analysing data that highlighted varying levels of prior knowledge and engagement.
- Teachers improved their practice by engaging in targeted professional learning focused on prayer, meditation, and liturgical expression.
- Teachers deepened student connections to faith by collaboratively planning and implementing lessons incorporating scripture, prayer, and meditation.
- Teachers supported student reflection and participation by applying evidence-based strategies, modelling prayer practices, and encouraging student-led discussion.
- Students demonstrated growth in understanding and confidence by completing mind map post-assessments.
- Teachers refined ongoing teaching and feedback by analysing assessment results.

Impact on student learning:

- **Impact on student understanding of prayer and liturgical expression:** Students demonstrate a deeper understanding of different forms of prayer, meditation, and liturgy, and are increasingly able to articulate their significance in their faith journey.
- **Impact on connections between faith and life:** Students make authentic connections between scripture, prayer, and their daily lives, showing an improved ability to reflect on and express their personal faith experiences.
- **Impact on Catholic Identity:** Students show increased awareness of how Catholic Identity shapes their values, choices, and interactions with others.
- **Impact on engagement in Religious Education:** There is increased student participation in classroom and school-wide prayer experiences, with greater enthusiasm and willingness to engage in discussions about faith and spirituality.
- **Impact on sense of community and belonging:** Students feel more connected to their peers and teachers through shared prayer experiences and demonstrate a deeper appreciation of their role within the Catholic school community.
- **Impact on Catholic Identity data:** MACSSIS survey responses indicate a stronger student connection to faith, with growth in positive attitudes toward prayer, meditation, and liturgical participation.

Value Added

- The Sacraments are a central aspect of the faith life at our school, playing a vital role in nurturing the spiritual growth of our students. Students are given the opportunity to deepen their relationship with God through the Sacraments of Reconciliation in Year 3, First Eucharist in Year 4, and Confirmation in Year 6. These significant milestones are supported by rich learning experiences, prayerful preparation, and strong partnerships with families and the parish.
- Christian meditation is an important part of Good Shepherd, with students participating each morning before class to begin the day calmly and with focus, supporting their concentration and fostering a sense of peace, reflection, and connection to their faith.
- We regularly celebrate together at Mass and in school-based liturgies, with students also attending year level Masses. We embrace the opportunities to gather with the Parish community, and these experiences of worship build a strong sense of connectedness between the school and the wider Parish.
- Classes take turns to run Prayer of the Air every Friday. The theme, Readings, Prayers and Music focus on the Gospel for the coming Sunday or Feast Day. Students are involved in the creation and presentation of their class Prayer of the Air. Students are able to explore the Gospel or Feast Day in depth and share their knowledge with the whole school.
- Good Shepherd school staff have engaged in Professional Development to enrich their knowledge and understanding of the curriculum and prayer whilst continuing to develop their own sense of faith. Staff have been involved in Professional Development that focused on enabling them to bring prayer and the Catholic Tradition to life through making meaning.
- Students actively participate in social justice initiatives such as Project Compassion and St Vincent de Paul, developing an awareness of the needs of others and a commitment to compassion and service.

Learning and Teaching

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goals:

- To improve student achievement in mathematics, particularly in counting and place value in Year 1.
- To improve student achievement in reading comprehension in Year 2.

Targets:

- By the end of the year, in the Mathematics Online Interview (MOI), all Year 1 students will achieve the expected growth point 3 or higher in Counting, and growth point 2 or higher in Place Value.
- By the end of the year, in the Progressive Achievement Tests (PAT) Reading, all Year 2 students will achieve the expected mean score of at least 101.1.

Key Improvement Strategies

- If we use an explicit instruction approach to build fluency and number sense in Mathematics, then we will improve the proficiency of students in counting and place value in Year 1.
- If we use an explicit instruction approach to build understanding of a text in Reading, then we will improve student achievement in reading comprehension Year 2.

Achievements

The following targets were partially met:

- **Improved Counting and Place Value Skills:** Students demonstrated improved skills in counting forwards and backwards from various starting points and knowing one more or less than any given two digit number. Students also demonstrated improved skills in reading, writing, interpreting and ordering two digit numbers. Students were also exposed to the same practices with three digit numbers.
- **Increased Student Engagement:** Students were more actively involved in mathematics lessons, participating in daily review sessions. Most Year Two students were also actively involved in reading lessons, participating in discussions, asking questions, and applying comprehension strategies.
- **Higher PAT Early Years Mathematics/Reading Scores:** By the end of the year, most students showed measurable improvements in their Progressive Achievement Test (PAT) Mathematics scores, with the majority (75%) achieving the target mean score of

at least 99.4. Evidence, as reflected in the final PAT Early Years Mathematics results, showed 95% of students demonstrated progress over time. Similarly, most students (94%) showed measurable improvements in their Progressive Achievement Test (PAT) Reading scores, with the majority (76.5%) achieving the target mean score of at least 101.1.

- **Stronger Retention and Application of Skills:** Most Year One students were able to apply and retain counting and place value strategies with numbers to at least 120 through the explicit teaching practices and daily review sessions. Most Year Two Students retained and applied reading comprehension strategies across different texts and subjects.
- **Improved Reading Comprehension Skills:** Most Year Two students were able to demonstrate a deeper understanding of texts, showed improved ability to identify main ideas, make inferences, and summarise key points.
- **More Independent and Confident Readers:** Students became more confident in their ability to approach and understand new texts on their own.
- **Increased Critical Thinking and Discussion:** Students developed fluency in place value and counting, which supported problem-solving tasks. They were also able to engage in more sophisticated discussions about texts, demonstrating critical thinking and the ability to analyse and evaluate information.
- **Better Student-Teacher Interaction:** As students became more skilled in reading comprehension, they engaged in more meaningful interactions with teachers, sought clarification, explained their thinking, and reflected on their learning.

Impact on teacher/leader practice:

- By increasing consistency in adapting and sustaining evidence-based explicit instructional practices aligned to the Vision for Instruction, and using MACS Ochre resources, teachers delivered more structured and focused lessons across the school.
- By using MACS Mathematics Ochre resources, inclusive of daily reviews from Prep to Year 6, teachers enabled curriculum equity across all year levels, ensuring that all aspects of the Victorian Curriculum 2.0 were taught incrementally.
- By using MACS Mathematics Ochre resources from Prep to Year 6, teachers supported the enhanced explicit teaching of specific strategies and subject-specific mathematical vocabulary.
- By implementing, refining, and reflecting on specific teaching practices, particularly choral responses, cold calling, mini whiteboards, and probing questions through using the MACS Walkthrough Hub, teachers were able to regularly self-reflect, share strategies, and collaborate within year-level teams and across the wider school community.
- By carrying out leadership-led learning walks, leaders were able to gauge the school-wide implementation of explicit instruction practices and collaboratively narrow the focus on next steps through professional learning meetings and whole-school closure days.

- By participating in learning walks across the school, leaders were able to provide general feedback to teaching staff, including affirmations (WWW – what’s working well) and considerations (EBI – even better if), particularly within the subject of Mathematics.
- By modelling specific teaching strategies in classrooms and during professional learning meetings, and by providing rich digital examples of teaching practices aligned with professional readings, leaders enabled teachers to refine their practice.
- By analysing PAT Data Explorer resources, including report types, and creating whole-school aligned Google Sheets, teachers became more confident in reading and interpreting results and in writing more precise student reports.
- By reflecting on PAT growth scores and comparing different data sets, teachers strengthened their ability to triangulate student results and identify required adjustments to meet the needs of all students.
- By sharing and unpacking the DIBELS (Dynamic Indicators of Basic Early Literacy Skills) screener with teachers, leaders enabled staff to track student progress and identify reading difficulties in phoneme segmentation, decoding, oral reading fluency, and comprehension.
- By up-skilling teachers and LSOs in strategies to develop number sense and build fluency in counting and place value, through the use of concrete materials, staff were able to pinpoint gaps in students' mathematical skills and provide targeted support aligned to the MOI screener and the Year 1 Number Check.

Impact on student learning:

- **Impact on implementing consistent school-wide approaches based on explicit instructional practices in mathematics using Ochre resources:** Using this approach enabled all students to access carefully sequenced, structured teaching without overloading their working memory. Incorporating daily reviews ensured students practised fluency and automaticity. Because instruction is modelled and highly scaffolded, students are less likely to practise ineffective strategies. The Ochre resources also unpack specific mathematical language and concepts.
- **Impact on implementing, refining, and reflecting on specific teaching practices aligned to the Vision for Instruction:** Choral responses allow every student to rehearse and articulate their thinking in a supportive environment. Using teaching techniques such as cold calling, mini whiteboards, and specific checks for understanding (hinge questions) ensures all students are cognitively engaged, not just those who volunteer. These strategies provide immediate formative assessment for teachers and enable responsive teaching when addressing misconceptions. Instruction can be adjusted in the moment to meet the needs of students.
- **Impact on unpacking formative assessment data:** When teachers are able to effectively unpack formative assessment data such as PAT, DIBELS, and MOI, they can identify the specific skills and concepts students have mastered and those they are ready to learn next. When teaching teams consistently analyse whole school data, it strengthens coherence across the school, supports smoother transitions between year

levels, and enables teachers to track student growth over time. As a result, students experience more targeted teaching, clearer learning pathways, and earlier intervention, leading to stronger academic growth. The key difference is that data shifts from being simply collected to being actively used, which directly improves teaching precision and enhances student outcomes.

- **Impact on the leadership team participating in learning walks:** When the leadership team examines classroom environments through regular learning walks, the impact is significant for both teaching quality and whole-school improvement. Learning walks provide leaders with real time, in context insights into how teaching practices are enacted, how students are engaging, and how the learning environment supports the MACS Vision for Instruction. Rather than relying on perception or isolated data points, these observations develop a clearer understanding of strengths and areas for future growth across classrooms, year levels and the whole school.

Student Learning Outcomes

In 2025, student learning outcomes in NAPLAN demonstrated strong achievement and growth across all assessed domains. Our school achieved a 99.4% participation rate, well above the national average of 95%, ensuring reliable and comprehensive data. Year 3 students attained average scores of 446 in Reading, 434 in Writing, 444 in Spelling, 472 in Grammar, and 445 in Numeracy. Year 5 students achieved average scores of 531 in Reading, 529 in Writing, 542 in Spelling, 532 in Grammar, and 550 in Numeracy. When comparing NAPLAN results against the state and the nation, we were well above the mean across all areas. Our results indicate that we are within the expected range when comparing results with students from similar backgrounds.

Analysis of the 2025 NAPLAN data highlights a clear trend of sustained student growth between Year 3 and Year 5, particularly in the core areas of Writing and Numeracy. Additionally, 90% of our 2024 Year 6 cohort demonstrated medium to high growth in Reading when compared with students across the country. This reflects the impact of the school's explicit teaching practices, consistent implementation of the MACS Vision for Instruction, and a strong focus on early intervention and systematic improvement in literacy and numeracy outcomes. Moving forward, the school will continue to strengthen these evidence-based approaches to ensure every student experiences ongoing academic growth and success.

Furthermore, the ongoing tracking of whole-school formative assessment data, including PAT growth across the year and over time, alongside the implementation of DIBELS, will further strengthen teachers' ability to triangulate data. This will enhance the connection between assessment and explicit teaching practice by enabling teachers to more precisely identify student strengths, misconceptions, and learning gaps, and to respond through targeted teaching.

A range of targeted intervention strategies and specialist programs contributed to these strong outcomes. These included small-group intervention programs in literacy and numeracy, as well as the implementation of Personalised Learning Plans for students requiring additional support. These approaches ensured that explicit instruction was extended through tiered support structures, enabling timely intervention, increased student access to core knowledge, and improved learning equity across the school.

NAPLAN - Proportion of students meeting the proficient standards					
	2025 (current year)			2-Year Average	
Domain	Year level	Mean Scale score	Proficient	Mean Scale score	Proficient
Grammar & Punctuation	Year 3	443	67%	458	77%
	Year 5	566	87%	549	85%
Numeracy	Year 3	445	77%	449	83%
	Year 5	550	87%	544	88%
Reading	Year 3	446	84%	452	89%
	Year 5	531	95%	527	90%
Spelling	Year 3	444	84%	448	85%
	Year 5	542	92%	538	91%
Writing	Year 3	434	89%	447	91%
	Year 5	529	91%	530	91%

*A school's NAPLAN test must have a minimum of 11 participants and 80% participation rate. Data not reported for 2025 due to participation not meeting these criteria or no students were assessed. Participants include students who were assessed, including non-attempt, or those exempted from the test.

Student Wellbeing

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To improve social-emotional wellbeing of Year 4 students.

Target:

By the end of the year, in the Progressive Achievement Tests (PAT) Social and Emotional Wellbeing (SEW) Survey, 90% of Year 4 students will indicate an overall social-emotional wellbeing of 'developed' or above.

Key Improvement Strategy:

If we use explicit teaching strategies to teach Student Wellbeing, then we will improve social-emotional wellbeing of Year 4 students.

Achievements

This target has not yet been met and remains ongoing:

- Based on 2025 wellbeing data, this target was not met as 65.2% of students were at 'developed' or above, 15.6% emerging and 1.8% low
- Data interpretation must consider context: not all students completed the test, and student responses reflect internal perceptions rather than observable skills or behaviours, which can be influenced by personal circumstances or interpretation of questions.
- While the target was not met, Year 4 students demonstrated social and emotional growth in observable ways and revealed growth in selected wellbeing domains, which could suggest increased sense of happiness, improvement in family connectedness, reduction in emotional reactivity and a positive improvement with emotional regulation

Impact on teacher/leader practice:

- By auditing existing student wellbeing practices, we had an increased consistency of wellbeing practices across Year 4, resulting in clearer expectations and shared approaches among teachers.

- By using student wellbeing assessments, we were able to identify priority areas and adjust classroom strategies, so there was a more purposeful use of wellbeing data in planning.
- By engaging in professional discussions, we used wellbeing data to reflect on their practice and share effective strategies.
- By introducing additional resources, including the Resilience, Rights and Respectful Relationship program, we were able to strengthen and complement the whole school approach, The Resilience Project.
- By conducting learning walk-thrus, teachers were given feedback about their lessons, while leaders were able to reflect on and strengthen the implementation of the wellbeing program.
- By deepening our understanding of the MACS Vision for Engagement, we better connected this framework to classroom wellbeing programs.

Impact on student learning:

- **Engagement:** Students demonstrated greater engagement during explicit student wellbeing lessons by actively listening, participating in discussions, asking insightful questions, and by showing interest in the activities.
- **Targeted Support:** By using student wellbeing data to inform teaching, students received support that addressed their specific needs.
- **Happiness and Wellbeing:** More students reported feeling happy, with the proportion of Year 3 girls seeing themselves as a “happy person” increasing from 86.6% in 2024 to 94.1% in 2025.
- **Stronger Family Connections:** Students reported improved relationships at home, with 91.4% of Year 4 girls saying “they get along pretty well with family members,” up from 73.1% in 2024.
- **Safety and Confidence:** Students felt safer and more secure, with an increase from 81.6% identifying they feel “safe and free from danger” to 93.1%.

Value Added

At Good Shepherd School, student wellbeing is central to learning and a thriving community. The school fosters a respectful, safe, and inclusive environment where every child feels valued and supported. Student wellbeing is addressed holistically - supporting physical, emotional, social, academic, moral, and spiritual development.

Good Shepherd School continues to strengthen student learning and wellbeing through a range of initiatives that enrich the educational experience and support the development of the whole child. This includes:

- **The Hub:** A calm, supervised indoor space that provides students with a supportive environment during break times, promoting emotional regulation and positive social connection.

- **The Sanctuary:** A low-sensory outdoor space, supervised during play times to offer students a quiet and calming environment that supports wellbeing and self-regulation.
- **The Resilience Project:** A whole school program which promotes gratitude, empathy, mindfulness and emotional literacy.
- **House Points:** Our whole school positive behaviour system that recognises and reinforces students' efforts, achievements, and demonstration of school values.
- **The Buddy Program:** fosters connection and inclusion, building strong relationships between students and encourages a sense of belonging within the school community.
- **Student Voice:** Student voice and leadership are promoted through our Student Representative Council, as well as a range of Year 6 leadership roles that build confidence, responsibility, and collaboration.
- **Nationally recognised events:** Good Shepherd actively promotes a culture of respect and inclusion through the celebration of key events such as Harmony Day and Bullying: No Way! Week
- **Ongoing training:** Staff continue to engage in ongoing professional learning, particularly in the areas of Vision for Engagement, Child Safe Standards, Mandatory Reporting and inclusive education practices through the Nationally Consistent Collection of Data (NCCD), ensuring all students are supported effectively.
- **Wellbeing Intervention:** Targeted support for students who need social and emotional assistance, delivered in collaboration with families and teachers to promote positive wellbeing and engagement.
- **Communication with families:** We welcome open communication with our families and use a number of platforms including newsletters, email, overviews, parent/teacher meetings.

Student Satisfaction

The 2025 MACSSIS Survey results highlight a strong sense of belonging, a supportive learning environment and a positive school culture at Good Shepherd.

Students feel both supported and challenged in their learning, with 87% saying their teachers encourage them to do their best and 84% acknowledging that teachers take time to ensure they understand the material. 71% of students are excited to go to their class, well above the MACS average.

The school climate is respectful and engaging. 86% of students feel respected by their teachers, 82% recognise that there are supportive adults at the school to help them and 75% of students feel accepted for who they are.

These results demonstrate that Good Shepherd has cultivated a highly positive and inclusive school environment where students feel supported academically, socially and emotionally.

Student Attendance

At Good Shepherd, maintaining regular school attendance is a shared responsibility that supports student wellbeing and academic success. Attendance is recorded twice daily by teaching staff using the nForma platform, with all absences documented, including reasons provided by parents or carers.

Unexplained absences are followed up promptly by administration staff, usually through a phone call or message, to ensure students are safe and accounted for. This timely follow-up helps foster strong communication between home and school.

When ongoing or concerning patterns of non-attendance are identified, the school initiates contact with families to explore underlying causes. This may include health concerns, family circumstances, or social-emotional factors. Good Shepherd works collaboratively with families to provide appropriate support, which may involve wellbeing staff, external agencies, or tailored learning adjustments.

These processes reflect the school's commitment to student engagement, safety, and holistic development.

Average Student Attendance Rate by Year Level	
Y01	91.77
Y02	91.8
Y03	91.62
Y04	90.91
Y05	91.55
Y06	91.59
Overall average attendance	91.54

Leadership

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goals:

- To strengthen our Catholic identity through the faith formation of staff.
- To establish whole school processes and utilise professional learning to enhance pedagogical practice.

Intended Outcomes:

- That partnerships with the parish and wider school community are enhanced.
- That students are engaged in Religious Education that makes authentic connections with faith and life.
- That all staff regularly engage in learning that builds capacity and confidence, that positively impacts student learning.
- That there is shared accountability and responsibility for the improvement of students.

Targets:

MACSSIS

- From 2025 to 2028, MACSSIS Staff Data will demonstrate a consistent minimum of 70% overall school positive endorsement in the domain of 'Professional Learning', 70% of 'Collaboration Around an Improvement Strategy' and 65% of 'Instructional Leadership'.
- From 2025 to 2028, MACSSIS Staff data will demonstrate a consistent minimum of 70% overall positive endorsement in the domain of Catholic Identity across the school.
- From 2025 to 2028, MACSSIS Student data will demonstrate a consistent minimum of 70% overall positive endorsement in the domain of Catholic Identity across the school.
- From 2025 to 2028, MACSSIS Family data will demonstrate a consistent minimum of 70% overall positive endorsement in the domain of Catholic Identity across the school.

Learning and Teaching Planning

- For 80% of Teaching Staff to have Documented and enacted Professional Learning Plans
- For 60% of Support Staff to have Documented and enacted Professional Learning Plans

Accreditation

- 70% of our Teaching staff have their Accreditation to Teach Religious Education

TAP Hours

- All staff who have their Accreditation to Teach Religious Education to maintain 10 hours annually.

Achievements

In 2025, Good Shepherd continued to strengthen its leadership capacity with a clear focus on faith formation, evidence-based teaching practice, and whole-school improvement. Building on the foundations established during the School Review year, leadership prioritised the development of consistent, high-impact practices across all domains, with a strong emphasis on shared accountability, staff growth, and improved student outcomes.

Strengthening Catholic Identity and Faith Formation

A key leadership priority was deepening Catholic identity through the faith formation of staff and the integration of faith into daily school life. Staff engaged in targeted professional learning in Christian meditation, the Year of Jubilee, and prayer and liturgical practice. This resulted in more consistent and meaningful opportunities for students to engage in prayer, reflection, and scripture.

These efforts contributed to measurable improvements in student outcomes. Year 6 students exceeded the target in the Catholic Identity domain of the MACSSIS survey, achieving 66% positive endorsement. Students demonstrated a deeper understanding of prayer and stronger connections between faith and daily life, supported by consistent whole-school practices such as meditation, liturgy, and engagement with the parish and social justice initiatives.

Enhancing Teaching and Learning Through Evidence-Based Practice

Leadership played a central role in embedding the MACS Vision for Instruction through a consistent, school-wide approach to explicit teaching. The implementation of Ochre Education resources, alongside targeted professional learning, strengthened teacher capacity to deliver structured, sequenced, and high-impact lessons in both literacy and numeracy.

Leaders facilitated learning walks, modelling, and coaching to support the consistent application of effective instructional strategies, including choral response, cold calling, and formative assessment practices. The use of data was significantly strengthened, with staff developing greater confidence in analysing and triangulating assessment data such as PAT, DIBELS, and MOI to inform targeted teaching.

These approaches contributed to strong student learning outcomes, including NAPLAN results that were above state and national averages across all domains, and clear evidence of sustained growth in key areas such as reading and numeracy.

Building a Culture of Professional Growth and Collaboration

Leadership continued to prioritise professional learning as a driver of school improvement. Staff engaged in a wide range of professional learning opportunities aligned with school goals, including inclusive education, child safety, explicit teaching practices, and student wellbeing.

Professional Learning Plans were implemented to support staff growth, while participation in networks, conferences, and collaborative forums strengthened leadership practice and whole-school coherence. There was a strong focus on building collective efficacy, with staff working collaboratively through professional dialogue, shared planning, and reflective practice.

MACSSIS staff data reflected this positive shift, with notable improvements in perceptions of leadership, collaboration, and psychological safety. These results highlight a strengthening culture of trust, shared responsibility, and continuous improvement.

Strengthening Wellbeing and Engagement Through Strategic Leadership

Leadership supported the implementation of a more consistent and data-informed approach to student wellbeing, aligned with the MACS Vision for Engagement. While the Year 4 wellbeing target was not met, leadership ensured that data was used thoughtfully to inform practice, recognising both the limitations of perception-based data and the importance of observable student growth.

Leaders supported staff through professional learning, learning walks, and the introduction of complementary programs such as Respectful Relationships and The Resilience Project. As a result, students demonstrated increased engagement, improved emotional regulation, and stronger connections with peers and family.

Whole-school wellbeing initiatives, including The Hub, The Sanctuary, and student leadership opportunities, further contributed to a safe, inclusive, and supportive learning environment.

Strengthening Partnerships with Families and the Community

Leadership continued to enhance partnerships with families and the wider community through clear communication, inclusive practices, and meaningful engagement opportunities.

The implementation of the MACS Vision for Engagement supported a more intentional and consistent approach to building strong home-school relationships.

Family engagement remained high, with strong participation in school events and positive feedback reflected in MACSSIS data. High levels of parent satisfaction were evident across key domains, including communication, school climate, and Catholic identity, reinforcing the school's commitment to a welcoming and connected community.

Looking Ahead

The achievements of 2025 reflect a leadership team committed to building a cohesive, faith-filled, and high-performing school. Through a focus on evidence-based practice, faith formation, and collaborative culture, Good Shepherd has strengthened its foundations for sustained improvement.

These achievements position the school strongly as it continues to enact its School Improvement Plan, with a clear focus on enhancing student learning, wellbeing, and engagement, while nurturing a vibrant Catholic identity across the entire school community.

Expenditure And Teacher Participation in Professional Learning
List Professional Learning undertaken in 2025
Child Development, Neurodiversity and Inclusive Education Staff participated in a professional learning session led by Sandhya Menon, psychologist, author, and owner of Onwards and Upwards Psychology. Sandhya specialises in child development, neurodiversity, and inclusive education, and is dedicated to equipping educators with practical strategies to create inclusive classrooms. This session further strengthened staff capacity to adopt a neuro-affirming lens. Through the powerful personal experiences shared by staff, it was evident that our impact lies in challenging traditional narratives and reshaping them to better support all students, both within and beyond the classroom. Disability and Compliance As part of the Nationally Consistent Collection of Data (NCCD), staff completed modules on the Disability Standards for Education and engaged in Child Safety training to meet VRQA requirements and uphold the Child Safe Standards. Christian Meditation Staff engaged in professional learning focused on Christian meditation, deepening their understanding of its purpose, structure, and benefits for students. They explored practical strategies for guiding meditation, including the use of silence, stillness, and simple mantras. This learning was implemented across the school, with students participating in regular meditation sessions to support a calm, reflective start to the day and strengthen focus and connection to faith. The Year of Jubilee As part of their faith formation, staff explored the Year of Jubilee through sessions such as Signs of Hope and Anchored in Hope. These experiences deepened understanding of hope within the Church and supported staff in embedding these themes into teaching and school life, strengthening both personal faith and their capacity to guide students in living out hope. Health and Safety Training All staff completed First Aid, CPR, and Anaphylaxis training to ensure the safety and wellbeing of all students, particularly those with medical needs. Staff also participated in Emergency Management training aligned with the school's Emergency Management Plan (EMP), including core response procedures, and clarification of roles and responsibilities, including those of wardens.

Expenditure And Teacher Participation in Professional Learning

Leadership and Network Engagement

Members of the leadership team attended School Leadership Network Days, SILC School Improvement Network Collaboratives, and the MACS Flourishing Learners Conference. These opportunities strengthened strategic leadership, collaboration, and the sharing of best practices aligned with the Vision for Instruction.

Learning and Teaching

Selected staff participated in the Teaching for Impact in Mathematics (TIM) series in partnership with Teach Well, focusing on high-impact instructional practices using Ochre Education mathematics resources.

Teachers also engaged in professional learning based on the work of Tom Sherrington, exploring the WalkThrus Resource Hub and evidence-informed strategies to enhance student engagement and learning. These included techniques such as choral response, mini whiteboards, checking for understanding, and think–pair–share.

Staff undertook training in the administration of DIBELS, developing accuracy and consistency in assessment practices. Additional professional learning in ACER's Progressive Achievement Tests (PAT) supported teachers in measuring student proficiency in reading and mathematics, as well as tracking learning growth over time.

A dedicated school closure day focused on unpacking Ochre English resources, emphasising the importance of engaging with rich texts, explicit vocabulary instruction, and strategies to strengthen student comprehension.

Mandatory Reporting and Reportable Conduct

Staff completed the Mandatory Reporting and Other Obligations module to meet compliance requirements and strengthen child safety practices. Case studies were used to deepen understanding of mandatory reporting responsibilities, reportable conduct processes, and appropriate responses to child safety concerns.

Student Wellbeing and Engagement

Professional learning introduced the MACS Vision for Engagement, encompassing attendance, behaviour, belonging, learning, mental health and wellbeing, and motivation. Ongoing work with The Resilience Project supported staff to further embed emotional literacy, gratitude, empathy, and mindfulness practices within classroom contexts.

Number of teachers who participated in PL in 2025	32
Average expenditure per teacher for PL	\$1000.00

Teacher Satisfaction

The 2025 MACSSIS Staff Survey results reflect a highly positive and strengthened culture of trust, collaboration, and leadership at Good Shepherd.

Staff perceptions of leadership relationships were exceptionally strong across all measures. An overwhelming 98% of staff expressed confidence that school leaders act in the best interests of the school, while 94% indicated there is a high level of trust between staff and leadership. Relationships were further characterised by respect and approachability, with 96% of staff feeling respected by leaders and 90% feeling comfortable approaching the leadership team for support. Additionally, 94% of staff reported that leaders are supportive when challenges arise, and 96% acknowledged leaders' understanding of personal circumstances. These results highlight a leadership approach grounded in relational trust, care, and professionalism.

Staff also reported strong motivation and engagement in their roles, with 84% indicating that working with the leadership team motivates them. A positive and inclusive school culture was reinforced, with 90% of staff noting that leaders set a positive tone across the school and communicate effectively, while 92% felt that leadership clearly identifies goals and positively influences the quality of their work.

In the area of instructional leadership, staff confidence remained high. 90% of staff recognised leaders as knowledgeable about effective teaching and learning practices, and 92% affirmed that leadership communicates a clear and consistent vision for learning. This reflects the continued focus on embedding evidence-based teaching practices and aligning professional learning with whole-school improvement priorities.

Professional culture and collaboration were also key strengths. Staff reported strong alignment between professional learning and the School Improvement Plan (86%), as well as clarity around improvement strategies and team-based work. Support for teams remained high, with staff acknowledging that leadership provides clear direction and supports instructional decision-making. This is further reflected in the school's strong sense of collective efficacy, with 90% of staff confident in their ability to motivate students and support their learning growth.

Staff wellbeing and safety also remain a priority, with 86% of staff reporting a strong sense of success in their role. Psychological safety continued to be an area of focus, supporting a culture where staff feel increasingly able to share ideas, reflect on practice, and contribute to ongoing school improvement.

Catholic identity continues to be a visible and valued aspect of staff experience, with 96% of staff affirming that prayer is embedded in community events and 90% recognising the importance of staff leadership of prayer. Respect for Catholic beliefs remains strong, reinforcing the school's commitment to its faith-based mission.

These results demonstrate a cohesive and high-functioning leadership culture at Good Shepherd, where strong relationships, clear direction, and a shared commitment to improvement are driving both staff growth and student outcomes.

Teacher Qualifications	
Doctorate	0
Masters	6
Graduate	3
Graduate Certificate	1
Bachelor Degree	18
Advanced Diploma	3
No Qualifications Listed	13

Staff Composition	
Principal Class (Headcount)	3
Teaching Staff (Headcount)	45
Teaching Staff (FTE)	36.655
Non-Teaching Staff (Headcount)	26
Non-Teaching Staff (FTE)	14.75
Indigenous Teaching Staff (Headcount)	0

Community Engagement

Goals & Intended Outcomes

Goal:

To strengthen our Catholic identity through the faith formation of staff.

Intended Outcomes:

- Partnerships with the parish and wider school community are enhanced.
- Students are engaged in Religious Education that makes authentic connections between faith and life.

Target:

From 2025 to 2028, MACSSIS Family data will demonstrate a consistent minimum of 70% overall positive endorsement in the domain of Catholic Identity across the school.

Achievements

Good Shepherd School continued to provide rich and meaningful opportunities to strengthen partnerships between families, staff, the parish, and the wider community, successfully fostering a welcoming and inclusive Catholic school environment. This work has been further enhanced through the introduction of the MACS Vision for Engagement, which has supported more intentional and consistent approaches to family partnership and communication across the school.

Engagement with Families and the School Community

Strong family engagement remained a priority, with a range of opportunities provided for families to actively participate in school life. These included Parent-Teacher Meetings, Meet and Greet evenings, Grandparents Day, Whole School Sports Day, and regular school assemblies. Events such as annual school tours, twilight information evenings, and welcome packs for new families supported smooth transitions and a strong sense of belonging for new enrolments.

Family engagement was further strengthened through community events such as School Disco Night, Outdoor Cinema Night, Community Trivia Night, and Family Rollerama Night. The Parents and Friends Association played a key role in building community spirit through

fundraising and social initiatives, including sausage sizzles, and Mother's and Father's Day stalls.

Communication with families remained strong and consistent through platforms such as the nForma Portal, Seesaw, email, and regular school newsletters. The Termly Overviews and Learning Portfolios continued to provide families with detailed insights into classroom learning. The continued development and use of the nForma Portal significantly improved access to student reports and key school information, strengthening transparency and home-school partnership.

Faith Formation and Catholic Identity

Good Shepherd successfully strengthened student engagement with faith and Catholic identity through active participation in Sacramental Programs, in close partnership with the parish and families. Students demonstrated growing understanding of faith in action through meaningful opportunities for prayer, reflection, and service.

A strong culture of social justice and service was evident through initiatives such as the Christmas Hamper appeal for St Vincent de Paul and Project Compassion, where students across all year levels demonstrated generosity, compassion, and social responsibility.

Faith life was further enriched through community celebrations including the Feast of the Good Shepherd and the annual Carols Night, which strengthened students' connection to parish traditions and Catholic identity. These experiences supported the intended outcome of deepening students' spiritual development and sense of belonging within the Catholic community.

Student Voice, Leadership and Engagement

Student leadership and belonging were strengthened through the Student Representative Council (SRC), which provided a formal structure for student voice. SRC members actively contributed ideas, led initiatives, and represented their peers, developing leadership, confidence, and a deeper connection to school life.

Students were also engaged through a variety of structured and inclusive play opportunities, including the school's indoor passive play space, The Hub, and the outdoor passive play space, The Sanctuary. These intentionally designed environments are low sensory, safe, and carefully supervised, providing students with additional needs a supportive setting to regulate, connect, and engage in play at their own pace.

Both spaces also enable staff to model and facilitate appropriate play and social interaction, supporting students in developing confidence, communication skills, and positive peer relationships.

These opportunities supported student wellbeing, social connection, and collaboration across year levels, while ensuring all students have equitable access to meaningful and inclusive play experiences.

Community Partnerships and Enrichment

Connections with the wider community were strengthened through specialist sporting clinics delivered by local providers, including football and netball programs. These experiences offered students access to expert coaching while fostering meaningful links between the school and broader community networks. Our partnerships with feeder schools, Mazenod College, Avila College, and Sacred Heart Girls College, remain strong and highly valued, as they continue to support our students through a wide range of opportunities. These include musical enrichment through band programs, shared school performances, comprehensive transition initiatives, excursions, and regular on-site visits, all of which enrich student learning and support a smooth and confident progression into secondary education.

Cultural and Whole-School Engagement

Whole-school events continued to build strong community identity and pride. The biannual school production was a significant highlight, with the 2025 performance of Aladdin being a major success, showcasing student talent in the performing arts and strengthening whole-school engagement. Additional events such as the Music Gala, featuring junior and senior bands and choirs, further celebrated student achievement and fostered community connection through the arts.

Through these initiatives, Good Shepherd School has successfully strengthened its Catholic identity and deepened partnerships between school, parish, and families. The school continues to foster a faith-filled, inclusive, and connected community where students, families, and staff are actively engaged and supported in the shared mission of Catholic education.

Parent Satisfaction

The 2025 MACSSIS Survey highlighted strong levels of family satisfaction across several key domains at the school.

Family Engagement Domain

83% of parents reported that, based on their experiences within the school, they would be likely to recommend the school to prospective families.

Communication Domain

In terms of communication, 82% of families felt comfortable reaching out to the school for support, and 97% of families are accessing our online portal.

Catholic Identity Domain

Within the Catholic identity domain, 85% of parents felt that the Catholic mission is emphasised at their child's school. Additionally, 89% felt that respect for Catholic beliefs is promoted, and 89% believed that Catholic religious practices are meaningfully integrated into school life.

School Fit Domain

Regarding school fit, 84% of families felt that their child belongs at the school and 78% shared that the school considers their family's cultural background well. 75% felt that the school's overall approach to discipline works for their child, and 76% felt that the classroom learning experiences match their child's interests. Furthermore, 72% indicated that their child feels comfortable asking for help from school staff, and 79% felt that their child's teachers do well in meeting their child's learning needs.

School Climate Domain

In the area of school climate, 87% of families believed that other children enjoy attending the school. 92% felt that the school values the diversity of children's backgrounds. 93% felt that the staff respected the children, while 95% felt that children respect the staff. Additionally, 80% of families described the staff as approachable, and 78% felt the school leaders were approachable. A welcoming environment was noted by 89% of respondents when they entered the school, and 93% felt that the school's physical environment was suitable.

Financial Performance

The school's financial performance information and a report of the financial activities of the school's boarding premises (if applicable) have been provided to the Australian Charities and Not-for-profits Commission (ACNC) and will be available for the community to access from their website at www.acnc.gov.au.

For more detailed information regarding our school please visit our website at www.goodshep.vic.edu.au